

Haoxue Fan

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EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE **Brown University**, Providence, RI, USA
Research Associate Sept 2024 - Present
Postdoctoral Researcher 2026 - Present
Advisor: Dr. Matthew Nassar 2024 - 2026

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA, USA June 2024 - Aug 2024
Postdoctoral Researcher (Transitional Position)
Advisor: Dr. Samuel Gershman

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA, USA 2024
Ph.D., Psychology
Secondary Field in Computational Science and Engineering 2023
M.A. Psychology 2022
Advisor: Dr. Elizabeth Phelps

Peking University, Beijing, China 2019
B.S. in Psychology (Economics minor), *graduated with honors*

- PUBLICATION** (Trainee authors/presenters are underlined; *: Equal Contribution; Google Scholar)
1. **Fan, H.**, Dong, B., Benkelman, D. G., Rodman, A. M., Dorfman, H. M., Glimcher, P. W., & Phelps, E. A. (2026) Exerting effort for non-instrumental information under risk. *Scientific Report* pdf
 2. **Fan, H.**, Callaway, F., Gershman, S. J. (2025) Uncertainty-driven exploration in planning. *Decision* pdf
 3. Chen, Y.Y., Rosenbaum, G., **Fan, H.**, Flournoy, J., Li, T., Cegarra L., Yousoufian, A., Grad-Freilich, M., Kordyban, L., Mair, P., & Somerville, L. (2025). Prosocial motives differentially override default risk preferences across adolescence. *Open Mind* pdf
 4. Beech, A., **Fan, H.**, Shu, J., Oyarzun, J., Nadel, P., Karaman, O. T., Vranos, S., Phelps, E. A., & Kredlow, M. A. (2025). Using Natural Language Processing to Identify Patterns Associated with Depression, Anxiety, and Stress Symptoms During the COVID-19 Pandemic. *Journal of Affective Disorders* pdf
 5. Castillo, J*., **Fan, H***., Karaman, O.T., Shu, J., Stussi, Y., Kredlow, M.A., Vranos, S., Oyarzun, J.P., Dorfman, H., Sambrano, D., Merskin, R., Hirst, W., & Phelps, E. A. (2024) Overestimating negative emotion in autobiographical memory: evidence from memories for the COVID-19 pandemic and 9/11 attacks. *Cognition and Emotion* [pdf]
 6. Kredlow, M.A*., Oyarzun, J.P*., **Fan, H.**, Meskin, R., Hirst, W. & Phelps, E.A. (2024). Language use in narratives of the 9/11 attacks predicts long-term memory. *Emotion* [pdf]
 7. **Fan, H.**, Burke, T., Sambrano, D. C., Dial, E., Phelps, E. A., & Gershman, S. J. (2023) Pupil size encodes uncertainty during exploration. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience* [pdf]
 8. **Fan, H.**, Gershman, S. J., & Phelps, E. A. (2023) Trait somatic anxiety is associated with reduced directed exploration and underestimation of uncertainty. *Nature Human Behavior* [pdf]
 9. Hart, B., Achakulvisut, T., Adeyemi, A., Akrami, A., Alicea, B., Alonso-Andres, A., ... **Fan, H.**, ... & Wallisch, P. (2022). Neuromatch Academy: a 3-week, online summer school in computational neuroscience. *Journal of Open Source Education* pdf

PREPRINT

1. **Fan, H.***, Xia, A.*, Nassar, M., FeldmanHall O. (*submitted*) Asymmetric Social Ties Are Dynamic, Detectable, And Consequential For Inference pdf
2. Strittmatter, E., **Fan, H.**, Phelps E. A., Gershman S. J., Grote, G. (*submitted*) Uncertainty mindset intervention promotes uncertainty-as-enabling beliefs and modulates directed exploration pdf
3. Chen, Y.Y. *, **Fan, H. ***, Rosenbaum, G., Li, T., Flournoy, J., Mair, P., Cegarra L., Youssoufian, A., Grad-Freilich, M., Kordyban, L., Mair, P., & Somerville, L. (*submitted*). Developmental emergence of complex prosocial motives and their influence on risky decision making. pdf

PROCEEDING AND PUBLISHED ABSTRACT

1. **Fan, H.**, & Nassar, M. Task-irrelevant physical effort exertion boosts arousal and facilitates latent state update. *Computational Cognitive Neuroscience 2026* [pdf]
2. Chen, Y.Y., Rosenbaum, G., **Fan, H.**, Li, T., Flournoy, J., Mair, P., & Somerville, L. (2024). How beliefs around peers' risk preferences get incorporated into adolescents' decision making. In *Proceedings of the 46th Cognitive Science Society* [pdf]
3. Beech, A., **Fan, H.**, Shu, J., Oyarzun, J., Nadel, P., Phelps, E. A., & Kredlow, M. A. (2024). Differential language analysis of participant narratives and depression and anxiety symptoms during the COVID-19 pandemic. In *Abstracts from the 2023 Annual Meeting of the Society for Affective Science: Emotion and Mental Health. Affective Science*. [link]

HONORS AND AWARDS

Society for Neuroeconomics (SNE) Best Dissertation Award	2025
Derek Bok Center Teaching Certificate, Harvard University	2024
Restricted Fund (\$500×4), Department of Psychology, Harvard University	2023, 2024
Stimson Fund (\$1000), Department of Psychology, Harvard University	2023
Certificate of Student Recognition of Teaching, Harvard University	2022
Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Harvard University	2022
GSAS Professional Development Fund, Harvard University	2022
Silver Best Talk Award, Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting	2021
Outstanding Graduate Award, Beijing Municipal Education Commission	2019
College Student Research Program, Beijing Municipal Education Commission	2017
National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China	2017, 2018
Pacemaker to Merit Student, Peking University	2017, 2018
Xinhe Scholarship, Peking University	2016

INVITED TALK

Wise Lab (PI: Dr. Toby Wise), King's College London	2026
Affective Ecology Lab (PI: Dr. Yu Hao), Ningbo University	2026
Curiosity, Information Seeking & Exploration: From Neurons to Cognition (CISE) Conference website	2025
Computational Cognitive Science Journal Club, University of Maryland	2024
The Translational Lab (PI: Dr. Pete Hitchcock), Emory University	2024
Radulescu Lab (PI: Dr. Angela Radulescu), Mount Sinai Center of Computational Psychiatry	2023
Learning Memory & Decision Lab (PI: Dr. Matthew Nassar), Brown University	2023
MindRL Hub recording (Chinese)	2023
Social Decision Neuroscience Lab (PI: Dr. Patricia Lockwood), University of Birmingham	2023
SPAN Lab (PI: Dr. Brian Knuston), Stanford University	2023
Reviews Reading Group	2023
Rutledge Lab (PI: Dr. Robb Rutledge), Yale University	2023
Cognition, Brain, and Behavior Seminar, Harvard University	2023
Goldenberg Lab (PI: Amit Goldenberg), Harvard University	2023
Chinese Computational Psychiatry Association	2022
Otto Lab (PI: Dr. Ross Otto), McGill University	2021

**CONFERENCE
TALK**

Fan, H., Xia, A., FeldmanHall, O., & Nassar, M. (May 2025). Resolving uncertainty fosters tie formation in real-world social networks. Data Blitz Talk at *Trends in Psychology Summit, Cambridge, MA*

Beech, A., **Fan, H.**, Shu, J., Oyarzun, J., Nadel, P., Phelps, E. A., & Kredlow, M. A. (Nov, 2023). Differential language analysis of participant narratives and depression and anxiety symptoms during the COVID-19 pandemic. Symposium talk presented as part of "When is it Helpful to Revisit the Anxious Past? The Relevance of Symptom-Related Autobiographical Memories in Anxiety and Related Disorders" at *the 57th annual convention of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (Seattle, WA)*

Fan, H.*, Castillo, J.* , Karaman, O. T., Shu, J., Stussi, Y., Kredlow, M. A., Vranos, S., Oyarzun, J. P., Dorfman, H., Sambrano, D., & Phelps, E. A. (Nov, 2022). Over-estimating stress experienced early during the pandemic is associated with decreased emotional well-being. Symposium talk presented as part of "Exploring Relationships Between Various Cognitive Mechanisms and COVID-19 Emotional Distress" at *the 56th annual convention of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (New York, NY)*

Kredlow, M. A., Oyarzun, J. P., **Fan, H.**, Meskin, R., Hirst, W. & Phelps, E. A. (November, 2021). Do linguistic features of trauma narratives predict trauma-related emotions and memory over time? Symposium talk presented as part of "Making sense of trauma memories: Characteristics and responses to trauma narratives as predictors of PTSD outcomes" at *the 37th annual conference of the International Society for Traumatic Stress Studies (virtual)*

Fan, H., Gershman S.J., & Phelps E.A. (September, 2021). Trait somatic anxiety is associated with reduced directed exploration and underestimation of uncertainty. *Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting (virtual)*. **silver best talk award**

**CONFERENCE
POSTER**

Dorfman H. M., Aime-Sityanin G., **Fan H.**, & Phelps E. A. (July 2026). Individual differences in seeking and avoiding threatening information under certainty. *Computational Psychiatry Conference, New Haven, CT*

Fan, H., & Nassar, M. (Nov 2025). Behavioral signatures of rotational transfer learning in a spatial predictive inference task. *Society of Neuroscience Annual Meeting, San Diego, CA*

Fan, H., & Nassar, M. (Oct 2025). Behavioral signatures of rotational transfer learning in a spatial predictive inference task. *Society of Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting, Cambridge, MA*

Dorfman H. M., **Fan H.**, Aime-Sityanin G., & Phelps E. A. (June 2025). Individual differences in seeking and avoiding threatening information under certainty. *Reinforcement Learning & Decision Making Conference, Dublin, Ireland*

Fan, H., Xia, A., FeldmanHall, O., & Nassar, M. (May 2025). Resolving uncertainty fosters tie formation in real-world social networks. *Trends in Psychology Summit, Cambridge, MA*

Fan, H., Xia, A., FeldmanHall, O., & Nassar, M. (April 2025). Resolving uncertainty fosters tie formation in real-world social networks. *Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL*

Kasperek, W. S., **Fan, H.**, Cikara, M., & McLaughlin K. (March 2025). Altered affective attributions after childhood violence exposure and psychopathology risk *Society of Affective Science, Portland, OR*

Chen, Y.Y., Rosenbaum, G., **Fan, H.**, Li, T., Flournoy, J., Mair, P., & Somerville, L. (July 2024). How beliefs around peers' risk preferences get incorporated into adolescents' decision making. *Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam, Amsterdam*

Fan, H., Dong, B., Benkelman, D. G., Rodman, A., Dorfman, H. M., Glimcher, P., & Phelps, E. A. (Oct 2023). Bidding with Effort: Using Grip Force to Assess the Value of Information. *Society of Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada*

Fan, H., Gershman S. J., & Phelps E. A. (June, 2022). Trait somatic anxiety is associated with reduced directed exploration and underestimation of uncertainty. *20th Summer Institute on Bounded Rationality, Berlin, Germany*

Castillo, J.*, **Fan, H.***, Karaman, O. T., Shu, J., Stussi, Y., Kredlow, M. A., Vranos, S., Oyarzun, J. P., Dorfman, H., Sambrano, D., & Phelps, E. A. (May, 2022). Overestimating stress experienced early during the pandemic is associated with decreased emotional well-being. *Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting (virtual)*

Aslarus L., Kredlow, M.A., **Fan H.**, & Phelps, E.A. (May, 2022). Novelty Exposure Interferes with Visual Emotional Memory Consolidation. *Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting (virtual)*

Fan, H., Gershman S. J., & Phelps E. A. (Apr, 2021). Distinct Effects of Trait Anxiety Components on Exploration *Wisconsin Symposium on Emotion (virtual)*

Heffner, J., Son, J., **Fan, H.**, & FeldmanHall, O. (May, 2019). The Joy of Punishment: Early Emotional Reactions Predict Decisions to Restore Justice. *Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, Miami Beach, Florida*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor: Let me google it: Information seeking (avoidance) in everyday life, January 2021 (a five-lecture introductory psychology course)

Guest Speaker: PSYC 417: Data Science for Psychology and Neuroscience Majors, Department of Psychology, University of Maryland, Spring & Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant:

- PSY 1322: Decisions Big and Small: The Cognitive Science of Making Up Your Mind (Instructor: Dr. Tomer Ullman), Spring 2023 (Evaluation: 4.27/5)
- PSY 1901: Methods of Behavioral Research (Instructor: Dr. Mina Cikara), Fall 2022 (Evaluation: 4.68/5)
- PSY 1401: Computational Cognitive Neuroscience: Building Models of the Brain (Instructor: Dr. Samuel J. Gershman), Spring 2022 (Evaluation: 5/5)
- AM 207: Stochastic Methods for Data Analysis, Inference and Optimization (Instructor: Dr. Weiwei Pan), Fall 2021 (Evaluation: 4.75/5)
- online R workshop on Fundamentals of Tidyverse (Instructors: Drs. Kelly Bodwin & Hunter Glanz), Jan 2021

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

Certificate in Mentoring Undergraduates in Science, *Harvard University*, Apr 2022

Currently Mentored Undergraduates/Post-Bacs (*: thesis student):

Diana Szilagyi (2026-present); Charlotte Derway (2026-present); Lyons Wang* (2026-present; Awarded Undergraduate Teaching and Research Awards)

Previously Mentored Undergraduates:

Ellie Jeong* (2024-2026; Current: Clinical Research Assistant, Boston Children’s Hospital); Bryan Dong (2023-2024; Current: Psychology Graduate Student, University of Chicago), Emily Dial (2022-2024; Current: Philosophy Graduate Student, Tufts University), Dorothy Grace Benkelman (2023), Rachel Mehler (2023), Ecem Sena Uluegeci (2022-2023), Isabella Caterina Aslarus* (2020-2021; Current: Psychology Graduate Student, Stanford University)

AD HOC REVIEW

(*: co-review with mentor)

Conference proceeding and abstract: CCN, Cogsci, SAS, RLDM

Journal: Affective Science, Cognitive Affective, & Behavioral Neuroscience, Computational Psychiatry, Communications Psychology, eLife, Emotion, Frontiers in Behavioral Neuroscience, Frontiers in Psychology, Journal of Neuroscience, Journal of Open Source Software, Nature Communication*, Neuroscience and Biobehavioral Reviews, Open Mind, PLOS Computational Biology, Psychological Review, Psychological Science

SERVICE AND VOLUNTEER

Psychological Science REPEAT network volunteer, 2025-Present

Volunteer, *Brown Brain Fair*, 2025-Present

Best Poster Judge, *Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting 2025*, 2025

Mentoring Co-chair, *Harvard Graduate Women in Science and Engineering*, 2022 - 2024

Event Coordinator, *Harvard Women in Psychology*, 2021 - 2023

Graduate Student Interview Day Committee and Orientation Panelist, *Harvard University Department of Psychology*, 2022

PPREP Mentor and Identity and Empowering Panelist, *Harvard Prospective PhD and RA Event in Psychology*, 2020-2023

International Community Conversation Facilitator, *Harvard GSAS orientation*, Aug 2020

Student Salon Host, Theme: Studying emotion in decision-making. co-hosted with Dr. Ian Robert. *Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting 2021 (virtual)*, 2021

Video Caption Editor, *Neuromatch Academy 2020*, Aug 2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

R, Python, MATLAB, Javascript, Qualtrics, Git, L^AT_EX

REFERENCES

Elizabeth Phelps

Pershing Square Professor of Human Neuroscience, Harvard University

Department of Psychology and Center for Brain Science

phelps@fas.harvard.edu

Samuel Gershman

Professor, Harvard University

Department of Psychology and Center for Brain Science

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Matthew Nassar

Associate Professor, Brown University

Department of Neuroscience

matthew_nassar@brown.edu